



understand the domain better, but are also able to learn new technologies.

A real problem statement would read as follows: “Build a system that can help us distinguish forgeries from actual signatures. This system should be able to study signature parameters such as strokes, curves, dots, dashes, writing fluidity and style, in a writer-independent manner and create features for the identification of a signature.”

Along with real-world problems, developers have access to tons of resources on programming, data structure, and algorithms – all of which are essential for a good foundation in programming. We also have a rich library of articles and conduct webinars to help developers in upskilling.

Q What role has open source played in the success of HackerEarth? Which open source tools and programming languages do you use?

Open source has played a significant role in building HackerEarth from Day One. The primary operating system used is Ubuntu. The primary programming languages used are Python and JavaScript. A popular open source framework based on Python-Django powers most of HackerEarth. React, a JavaScript library for building user interfaces, is primarily used in the front-end. Buildbot, an open source framework for automating building, testing and releasing, is used for ‘continuous integration’ and ‘continuous deployment’ at HackerEarth.

Besides these, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Docker, Redis, Apache Kafka, Apache Thrift, RabbitMQ, NGINX, Apache HTTP server, InfluxDB, OpenVPN, Consul, Supervisor and Zookeeper are some of the other open source tools

in the HackerEarth infrastructure, which powers millions of developers, millions of code evaluations, and terabytes of project submissions in the cloud.

Q There are several new sectors that are adopting hackathons and coding challenges. Could you brief us about the technologies and languages that are being used nowadays?

Hackathons are no longer for coders only. We now see a lot of non-tech companies going in for hackathons as a platform for collecting ideas and prototypes. At HackerEarth, we have worked with several well-known brands such as the Future Group, Unilever, GE Healthcare, SBI, etc, to solve challenges ranging from customer data management to digital transformation in the banking sector. The technologies and languages being used the most during hackathons include HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Python, Java, PHP, etc.

Q Is finding ‘quality talent’ a challenge in India for open source?

Yes, finding quality talent in India for open source is an ongoing challenge. Many of the open source technologies like Python and Django have only recently become popular in India. As a result, the number of developers working with these technologies is comparatively less. However, the open source contributions from Indian developers are increasing and that’s a very healthy sign.

Q What type of skillsets do you seek in those you are hiring?

At HackerEarth, we look for knowledge in Python, Django, and experience in software development. Knowledge of React and JavaScript becomes a must for front-end engineers. At the same time, a good understanding of MySQL, RabbitMQ, Redis and other infrastructure tools is also important.

Q Can you share any unique hiring practice you follow to get the right candidates?

We recently hosted Djangothon, which was a hackathon exclusively for Python and Django developers. This helped us connect with a pool of passionate Django developers, many of whom were interested in working at HackerEarth due to our engineering challenges and expertise in Django. We also leverage the HackerEarth community to reach out to experienced developers who have the skillsets that we’re looking for. **END** 🐧